

DBS Group (DBSM.SI): Asia Financial Corporate Day Takeaways: Remaining steady

Asia Financial Services

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We hosted DBS at our Asia Financial Corporate Day on June 19th, 2025. Overall, the tone of the meeting was one of cautious optimism, with DBS expressing confidence in the stability in its operations despite the uncertainties in the environment: (1) Hedging to help mitigate the impact from the slump in HIBOR and SORA and strong CASA inflow to support NII; (2) Wealth continues its strong momentum especially in new money inflow; (3) Flexible cost management to provide cushion for the bottom line; (4) Asset quality remains benign and GP coverage sufficient for now.

Key Takeaways

■ Hedging to help mitigate the impact from the slump in HIBOR and SORA.

DBS noted that on the HK\$ book, though majority of the assets are pegged to HIBOR with limited hedging, the impact of a HIBOR decline is partially mitigated because half of the HK\$ deposit is on floating rate and approx. 25% of the HK\$ book is funded by USD swaps (also on floating rate). For the SG\$ book, DBS indicated that only 25% of the floating-rate IEAs, totaling S\$30bn, are linked to SORA. The remaining portion is tied to other benchmark rates, such as the internal cost of funds. DBS highlighted that the robust CASA inflow momentum continued in Apr, on the back of lower interest rates and flight-to-safety sentiment. Consequently, the bank may deploy excess liquidity to high-quality assets as per its previous practice, which is accretive to NII but dilutive to NIM. Apr NIM came in at 2.09%. We forecast 2025E NIM of 2.09%.

■ Wealth continues its robust momentum.

DBS noted that net new money in Apr was strong, recovering some of the outflow experienced in 1Q25. The bank expects to maintain an annual run rate of S\$20bn, similar to previous years' level based on the view that Singapore remains a key regional wealth hub, well-positioned as a haven in the current volatile environment. This is expected to help mitigate wealth income volatility arising from fluctuations in activity levels.

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We forecast fee income growth of 14% for 2025.

- **CIR to be in low 40s.** DBS expects mid-single digit growth in opex and CIR of low 40s. DBS also highlighted that a large chunk of its opex is performance-based, providing flexibility to absorb potential revenue shortfalls. We forecast CIR of 40.5% for 2025.
- **Asset quality remains benign.** In terms of SP, DBS maintained a positive view, seeing asset quality as still benign with no signs of deterioration, especially in the CRE segment, and reaffirms its 17-20bps guidance for 2025. Concerning its exposure to New World Development, DBS is undergoing some restructuring and has no further disclosure at the moment. As for GP, DBS believes the S\$200mn additional provision made in 1Q25 is sufficient, based on the current situation. We forecast CoC of 23bps for 2025.
- **Buyback plan is on track.** DBS has executed c.12% of its S\$3bn buyback plan. The bank aims to optimize the plan by increasing buybacks when the share price is low, while maintaining a consistent approach, without adhering to a specific timeline. DBS reiterated its capability to sustain S\$0.24 DPS step up in the next 2-3 years if ROE is maintained at 15%-17%. Regarding the additional S\$1.5bn excess held by the MAS, DBS will adopt a wait-and-see approach, suggesting a near-term release is less probable due to recent operational disruptions.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - DBS Group

We are Buy-rated on DBS with a 12-month target price of S\$54.8 (based on two-stage DDM). Key downside risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration in rate cuts; (-) Unexpected asset quality deterioration; (-) Mismanaged top management transition.

DBSM.SI	12m Price Target: S\$54.80	Price: S\$43.93	Upside: 24.7%		
Buy	GS Forecast				
		12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
	Market cap: S\$124.0bn / \$96.6bn	11,409.0	10,879.6	11,403.7	11,993.9
	3m ADTV: S\$257.5mn / \$196.1mn	4.01	3.86	4.07	4.32
	Singapore	10.9	(3.8)	5.7	6.0
	Asean Financials	8.9	11.4	10.8	10.2
	M&A Rank: 3	1.5	1.9	1.8	1.8
		1.5	1.3	1.3	1.3
		18.1	16.3	16.9	17.4
		9.3	9.1	8.8	8.3
		6.2	7.0	7.5	8.1
		3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
		1.02	1.00	0.95	0.86

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 19 Jun 2025 close.

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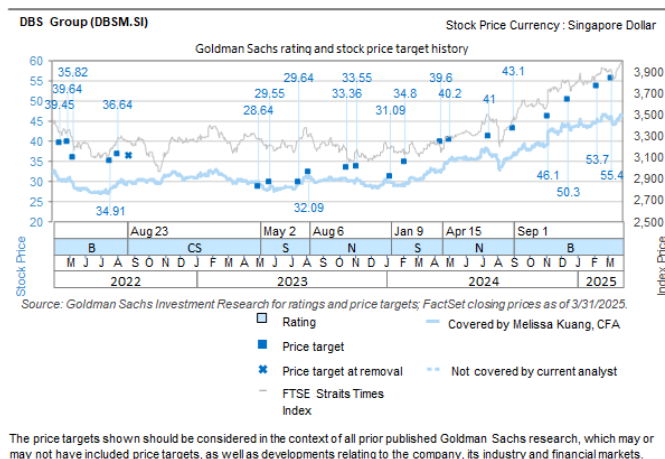
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